

PANSION

growth momentum. And it believes the party's just getting started **BY ARNAB DUTTA**

PHOTO BY **RAJWANT RAWAT**



packages PepsiCo snacks like Lays, Doritos, Cheetos, and Kurkure. But Jaipuria could only reap the benefits in FY23 because of the outbreak of the Covid-19 pandemic in 2020.

FACTORS IN FAVOUR

Jaipuria says two major factors played in his favour at that time. First, with the economy opening up post-pandemic, VBL increased its market coverage at a rapid pace. “It was only in 2022 and 2023 that we could ramp up on-ground coverage with manpower, infrastructure and distribution network, which are key to growing the business,” Jaipuria tells *Business Today*. And second, the overall infrastructure push by the government—by improving road connectivity and rural electrification—aided VBL’s business. Better road infrastructure helped it reach remote locations at lower costs, and the improving electricity supply in rural areas across north India meant VBL could put its freezers at retail outlets that had poor electricity connections earlier. After all, placing chilled bottles of colas in the neighbourhood is one of the most effective ways to lure consumers. “For many FMCG players, the rural market is not performing well. But with better infrastructure, we

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Big Ambitions Ravi Jaipuria,
Founder & Chairman, VBL